

TCB METAL WORKS

Custom Metal Fabrication · Racine, Wisconsin

Website Progress Report

Where the site stands today, how much stronger it is, and the plan to outrank our competitors at launch.

Prepared July 2026

A plain-English summary — no technical background needed.

OVERVIEW

Executive Summary

We rebuilt the TCB Metal Works website from the ground up. The old site was a small, template-based WordPress site with thin content and little search-engine setup. The new site is bigger, faster, better organized, and far more visible to Google.

This report explains, in plain terms, what has changed, roughly how much stronger the site is in each area, how we stack up against the competitors who currently outrank us, and the exact steps to top them once we launch.

The strategy in one line

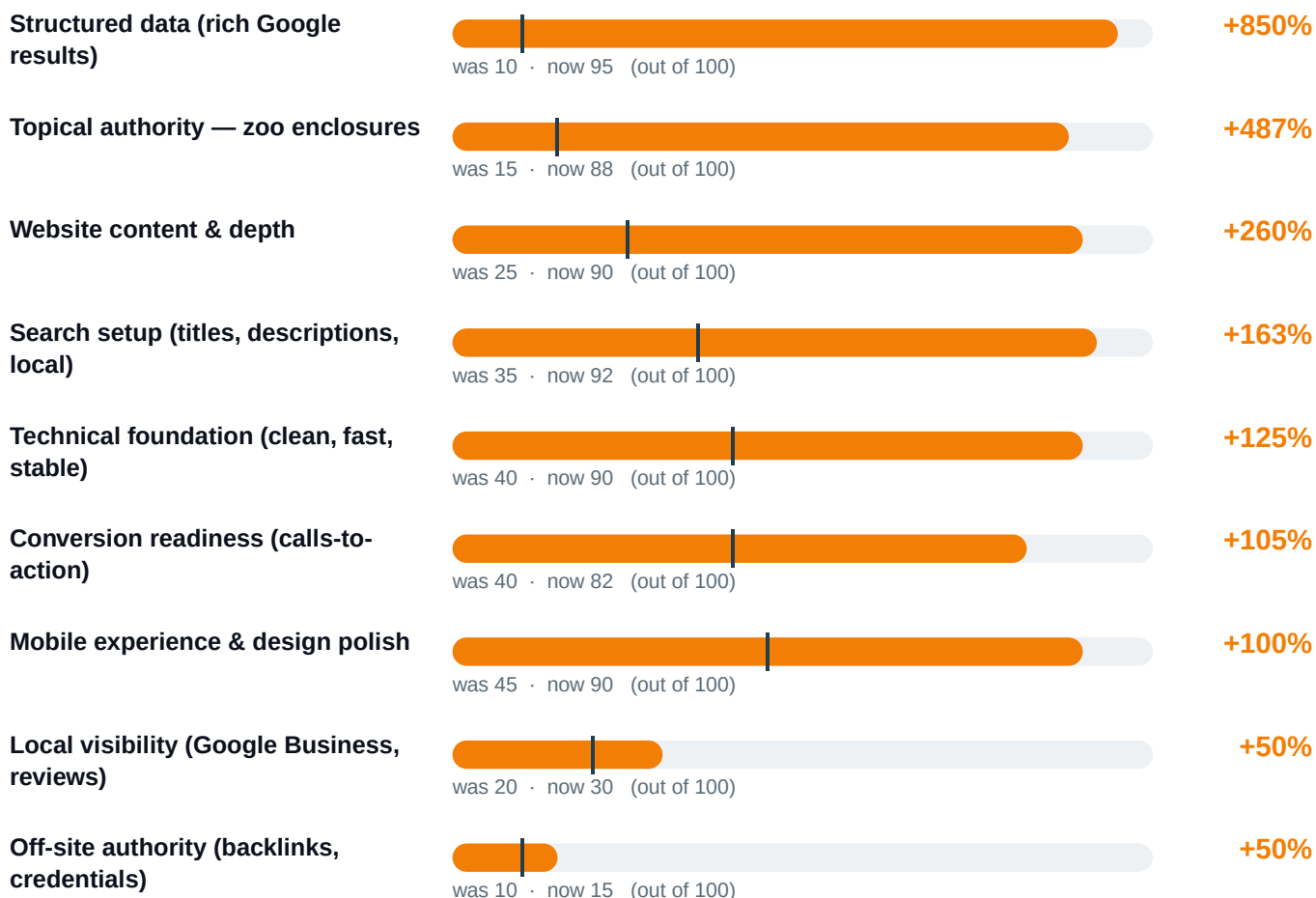
We can't out-age long-established competitors like Styberg (in business since 1927) or Otto Environmental (31 years). So we don't try to. Instead, we out-publish them — more useful content, clearer proof of our work, and a cleaner, more modern site. Two of the biggest remaining gaps can be closed in a matter of weeks.

A quick, honest note on the numbers in this report: the new site is not live yet, so these figures are informed estimates of how much each area improved during the rebuild — not measured traffic or ranking data. Real rankings and visitor numbers will be tracked after launch.

PROGRESS

How Much Stronger Is the Site?

Each bar below scores an important area from 0 to 100. The orange bar shows where the site is now; the small dark line marks where it started. The percentage on the right is the improvement.



Overall launch-readiness: roughly 27 to 78 out of 100 (about +190%)

Averaged across every area, the site's search-readiness has nearly tripled. The two areas still scoring low — local visibility and off-site authority — are done off the website (Google Business Profile, reviews, and backlinks), and they are the focus of the roadmap at the end of this report.

What We Built

The site by the numbers

- **20 pages published — up from a handful of thin pages on the old site.**
- 13 in-depth articles and blog posts — roughly 32,300 words of original, expert content written specifically for TCB.
- A flagship “Zoo Enclosures” section: a large cornerstone guide plus a full cluster of supporting guides (mesh systems, keeper doors, shift gates, squeeze cages, holding areas, enrichment, structural framing).
- Core business pages rebuilt: Home, Solutions/Services, Zoo Enclosures, Resources, Articles, About, and Contact.

Why Google will find and trust it

- Every page has a unique, keyword-focused title and description, plus local signals for Racine, WI.
- Rich-result data on every page — the behind-the-scenes information that lets Google show star-style extras like business details, FAQs, and breadcrumb trails.
- A complete sitemap and search-engine instructions so Google can discover all 20 pages quickly.
- Social-sharing cards so links look professional when posted on Facebook, LinkedIn, or texted.

How it looks and feels

- A polished “elevated industrial” brand look with custom fonts, brand colors, and subtle motion (including live welding-spark animation on the homepage).
- Fast, clean, hand-built code — no heavy page-builder bloat — with no layout “jumping” as pages load.
- Fully mobile-friendly and accessibility-aware (it respects visitors who prefer reduced motion).
- All 13 posts were edited to remove “AI-sounding” writing while keeping every search benefit intact.

Who Outranks Us Today — and Why

We researched the competitors who currently rank ahead of TCB and studied their sites. We compete on two separate fronts, each with a different set of rivals.

Front 1 — Zoo & animal enclosures (national)

This is our flagship. The good news: the single biggest opportunity in this market — genuinely helpful, in-depth guides — is a gap almost no competitor fills. We have already written that content. What we lack is published proof of our real projects and time-earned authority.

Competitor	Founded	Deep guides?	Named zoo clients	Where we stand
Otto Environmental (WI)	31 yrs	Limited	AZA-affiliated	Neighbor in WI; we can beat them on content depth
HebMetalMesh	20+ yrs	Yes (the only one)	None in the U.S.	We sell full steel fabrication + U.S.-based — stronger
RW Hardware	140+ yrs	Case-study library	Columbus Zoo, SeaWorld	Copy their case-study page format
Animal Caging & Enclosures	Est.	No	Greenville, U. of Miami, OKC	They use OUR client (U. of Miami) as proof
COST of Wisconsin	60 yrs	No	Denver, Cincinnati	Different niche (themed rockwork, not steel)

Our own client is being used against us

One competitor lists the University of Miami as a showcase project — the very same job TCB completed (stainless holding pens). We also built the Denver Zoo Australia cassowary exhibit. Neither is published on our site yet. Turning these two real jobs into proper case-study pages is our single highest-impact move.

Front 2 — Local metal fabrication (Racine / Milwaukee)

This front is won mostly off the website — through Google Business Profile, customer reviews, and business listings. Encouragingly, the local leaders have shallow review counts and weak technical setups, so there is a clear path in.

Competitor	Founded	Service pages	Certifications	Reviews	The opening
Styberg (Racine)	1927	9 pages	ISO, IATF, NADCAP	~3.3 stars	Beat on reviews + modern site
Cutting Edge Fab (Milwaukee)	1990	20+ pages	ISO 9001	—	Match their page depth
3Up Metal Works (Milw.)	Est.	9 pages	Veteran-owned	—	Match depth; we have zoo niche

Competitor	Founded	Service pages	Certifications	Reviews	The opening
racinefabrication.com	Est.	0 (one page)	None	None	Easy to leapfrog
Out-of-town template sites	—	City templates	None	No local address	We have a real Racine address, so we win the local map

THE PLAN

Roadmap to Beat Them & Rank #1

Four phases, ordered by return on effort. Each step is tied to a specific competitor number, so we always know exactly what “winning” looks like.

1

Ship the proof & structure

Pre-launch · Weeks 1–3

- **Publish 2 case-study pages: the Denver Zoo cassowary exhibit and the University of Miami holding pens.**

Why: RW Hardware, COST, and Animal Caging all rank on named projects — and a rival is already using our University of Miami job. This is the fastest, highest-impact win.

- **Build 7 deep service pages — welding, structural steel, steel/basement beams, machining, stainless, press brake, and custom truck beds.**

Why: Styberg has 9 service pages and Cutting Edge has 20+. One combined “Services” page cannot outrank them. Beams and truck beds have almost no local competition — easy wins to own.

- **Add local-business data and an embedded map to the contact and location pages.**

Why: none of the local competitors we studied have this — an instant technical edge.

Target for Phase 1

Match Cutting Edge's ~20 indexable service and proof pages — roughly doubling our current page count and giving Google far more ways to find us.

2

Win local visibility

At launch · Weeks 2–6

- **Claim and fully optimize the Google Business Profile at 1600 Layard Ave.**
- **Build consistent business listings on Yelp, Angi, BBB, and other directories — identical name, address, and phone everywhere.**
- **Run a review drive: aim for 25–30 Google reviews at 4.8 stars or higher.**

Why: the local leaders Styberg and Metalworld sit around 3.3 stars. Reviews are the single strongest factor in Google's local “map pack,” and with 120+ completed projects we have plenty of happy customers to ask. This one move can flip the local map results in our favor.

One thing to confirm

Our listed phone number uses a 224 area code, which is a Chicago-area code. For a Racine business, a local 262 number would strengthen our local ranking. Worth a quick decision before we build the listings.

Target for Phase 2

Reach the top 3 of the Google “map pack” for “metal fabrication Racine” — beating shallow-review incumbents on the signal that matters most locally.

3

Build lasting authority

Months 2–6

- Pursue industry memberships and certifications (AZA for zoos; AWS/AISC for welding and steel) and display the badges — Otto, COST, and Carter2 all rank partly on these.
- Earn backlinks: get our Denver Zoo and University of Miami projects mentioned by partners, and list TCB in zoo-manufacturer directories.
- Add a capabilities/equipment page (machine list, capacity, tolerances) — matching the authority signals Styberg uses.

4

Extend our content lead

Ongoing

- Publish a design guide for each animal type — lion, tiger, elephant, primate, aviary, reptile — each linking back to our main zoo guide.
- Why this wins: only one competitor (an overseas mesh seller) does this today, and we already lead on this kind of content. It is the softest flank in the entire market.
- Keep adding blog posts, plus dedicated city pages for Racine, Milwaukee, and Kenosha — backed by our real local address.

Bottom line

The rebuild has already nearly tripled the site’s search-readiness and, on content quality, put us ahead of the entire field. The remaining gaps — published proof, local reviews, and backlinks — are well understood and fully within reach. Ship the two case studies and the deep service pages, turn on the Google Business Profile and reviews, and TCB is positioned to lead both markets at launch.